

SURREY SCOUT

MARCH, 1980

No. 393

County Commissioner

"By appointment - purveyors of Commissioners and Chaplains to Headquarters."

In moments of whimsy I almost find myself doodling armorial bearings for the County in this traditional role! It is gratifying to reflect upon the fact over the years so many Headquarter Commissioners spent their formative Scouting years in Surrey, and now it is good to see that members of our County chaplaincy team are equally sought after for national preferment!

I am sure that all readers of "Surrey Scout" will join me in wishing the Rev. Father Barry Anderson every success as he takes on his new appointment as National Roman Catholic Chaplain in succession to the Rev. Father Roger Barralet. Barry will continue to live in Dorking where he started what is now a flourishing Group at St. Joseph's so it is nice to know that we shall continue to see him around the County. I hope it will not be long before I am able to announce the name of his successor.

The District Administrators' Conference at Surrey University on Sunday 3rd February was well attended with most of the Districts being represented. There was a useful interchange of views and I found it very encouraging that there was a demand not only for another similar conference next year but also for a smaller, weekend workshop in July 1980, at a venue yet to be finalised.

This evident desire on the part of Administrators, which is the correct collective noun for Chairmen, Treasurers and Secretaries - see Ted Hayden's article in the February edition of "Scouting" - and indeed, of Public Relations Officers/Advisers also, to become better informed about the nature of their responsibilities and how to discharge them, is most encouraging. It is very much in keeping with the hopes expressed, on every possible occasion, by the County

Chairman and myself, that we should all strive to adopt a more professional approach to the Scouting appointment we have undertaken and that applies to those involved in administration just as much as to all Warranted Scouters.

As I pointed out to those present at the Conference, I could not begin to do my job without the very professional support which I receive from our County Chairman, Geoffrey Wright, the County Treasurer, Doug. Bennett, and the County Secretary. Between them they provide the vital administrative support which enables all of the County team to carry out our responsibilities in support of the 20 Districts in the County.

A similar pattern should occur at District level where the Administration teams led by the District Chairmen should be doing everything in their power to make it possible for the District Commissioners, their A.D.C.s and District Scouter teams to provide the best back up support possible to the 250 Groups in the County.

The Groups are the front line of Scouting. All the action takes place at Group level and here too the pattern should be repeated yet again. The Group Chairman and Administration team in each Group should be fully alive to their responsibilities in supporting the Group Scout Leader and the Section Scouters as they strive to provide Scouting in all its wide variety of aspects for the Cub Scouts, Scouts and Venture Scouts in Surrey.

Privileges carry responsibility. But in Scouting the responsibilities which each of us undertake in any capacity, are a privilege which few would forego as we see our younger members progress through the Movement to grow into caring citizens.

GORDON BATES

Venture Scouts

National Scout Service, Windsor

For the first time since the Advance Party Report and the start of Venture Scouting, there is a restriction on the number of Queen's Scouts the County can send to the above Service this year. This is, of course, a great disappointment for those who will not be able to go but it does show that the challenging training programme for the third section is being used by Venture Scouts to complete their Scout training. It has taken too long for the programme to be universally accepted but the indications are that this is now the case. When I am privileged to present Queen's Scout Badges, the award holders always tell me that they have enjoyed the challenge and found it worthwhile.

Executive Committees

After all this time, I am still unhappy that there are people in the Movement who still do not understand the importance of the Executive Committee in the running of a Unit. We believe that the Sixers Council and the Patrol Leaders Council should help to run their sections, surely it is logical that to complete the training the unit should completely run

itself through the Executive Committee. Many people accept this but unfortunately forget that the Venture Scouts need to be trained to do it. It is not good enough to label a youngster chairman, secretary or treasurer and expect him or her to know exactly what to do. So please, everyone, help them to understand what committee work is.

County Camp

It was suggested at a recent meeting of the Venture Scout Sub-Committee that we should have a weekend camp, possibly on the South Coast, where units can meet other units to exchange ideas, discuss problems, etc. There will not be any activities because these would detract from the purpose. This camp will be held over the weekend July 18th/20th. Book the date in your programmes, details will be out soon.

County Competitions

For your programme planning the dates of the usual competitions this year are July 13th First Aid, October 12th Shooting, October 26th Cooking and November 15th/16th Venture Competition.

BRUCE WOOD

Leader Training Courses

Pack Holiday Course

Polyapes 11th, 12th, 13th April

General Information Courses

Dorking 30th March

Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Guildford 22nd/23rd March
Twickenham 12th/13th April
Woking 27th April & 11th May

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 28th/30th March
(residential)
Dulwich 12th/13th April
(G.L.-South Scout Centre)

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 22nd/23rd March

GROUP SCOUT LEADER

Croydon 8th/9th March

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 16th/18th and 23rd/25th March

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 7th/8th, 21st/22nd June and 5th/6th July

Water Activities Supervisory Skills Course

17th/18th May

Mrs. W. Viner, 58, West Bank, Dorking.

Mrs. J. Ludlow, 'High Banks', Harrow Road East, Dorking.

D. Brown, 21 Langsmead, Blindley Heath, Lingfield.
F. Kitchener, 19 Limewood Close, St. Johns, Woking.
J. Gibbons, 115 Hermitage Woods Crescent, St. John's Woking.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

J.E. Tivers, 69, Ashen Grove, S.W.19.

B. Wood, 'Ash Croft', 18 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham

J. Elliot, 22 Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

Information from J. Forbat, 46 Firlands, Ellesmere Road, Weybridge.

Pieces and Bits

Other publications

We are always delighted to receive District and Group Newsletters/Magazines. Amongst those recently received are:

Farnham District Newsletter
WASP - from Witley
Epsom and Ewell Scout News
East Surrey District Newsletter
Reigate Scouting News
Rabble Rowzer (11th Farnham)
5th Guildford Scout Group News
Woking Scout
The Surrey Mountaineer
Lash-Up (Sunbury & Shepperton)
Goose Green Gazette (Shere and Peaslake)
Dorking Scout News
Banstead District Scouts Newsletter
Godalming District Newsletter
Scouting in Runnymede
GLSW Newsletter
Surrey West Girl Guides Assoc. News Sheet
Saints Alive (SS Peter and Paul Group)
"?" (1st Horsley Newsletter)
Cygnus (1st Lightwater)

"Saints Alive" and "?" have just started and we wish both of these welcome additions a long and happy life.

Adoiliam '80

The 1st Shepperton Ranger and Venture Scout Units are organising a day wide-game in London on 4th May. Starting at the Royal Festival Hall, teams of four (mixed or otherwise) will cover about 5 miles. Invitations are extended to all Venture Scouts and Ranger Guides as well as older Scouts and Guides to take part, further details can be obtained by sending a self-stamped addressed envelope to Jacqui Langdon, 18 Ashley Park Crescent, Walton-on-Thames KT12

Carelessness?

The list of lost and found at any event is quite amazing, most things are small and just mis-laid. How, then, can Godalming District lose its Marquee??

Group Officials

And talking about Godalming, a very pleasant afternoon was recently spent with the Group Administrators of that District at a recent get-together. A get-together of such people is always worthwhile and Districts that haven't had such meetings yet, really are missing out. It's most encouraging that some idea or other nearly always emerges which deserves (and gets) a wider hearing.

Census

Will District Secretaries please note that as in previous years, Doug. Bennett is dealing with District Census Returns on behalf of the County Secretary. Accordingly, please take or send your completed District Return to "Pheasantwood", Sheephouse Lane, Wotton, Abinger Hammer, Dorking, Surrey RH5 6QL, as soon as possible, and certainly no later than 15th April.

Headquarters and County Subscriptions

Groups are reminded that Headquarters Subscriptions are due for payment on 1st April. Any Group which has difficulty in paying the full amount due to the District Treasurer at this date should advise the District Treasurer accordingly, and PAY WHAT IT CAN ON ACCOUNT.

District Treasurers are asked to pass onto the County Treasurer all monies received from Groups in respect of H.Q. Membership Subscription in any week, AT THE END OF THAT WEEK, and not to wait until a larger amount is available or until all Groups have paid in full. This will enable County to send monies to Headquarters as quickly as possible where it is sorely needed.

County Chaplain

As this will be the last time I'll be doing this column in "Surrey Scout", I would like to commend to you the following quote from Ed Murrow. He once wrote:

"Just for the beauty of the language, and the clarity of thought, I should like to read you the "complete" announcement speech in a half-dozen lines. They were written by the great German poet and philosopher, Goethe.

There are nine requisites for contented living:

- health enough to make work a pleasure;
- wealth enough to support your needs;
- strength to battle with difficulties and overcome them;
- grace enough to confess your sins and forsake them;
- patience enough to toil until some good is accomplished;
- charity enough to see some good in your neighbour;
- love enough to move you to be useful and helpful to others;
- faith enough to make real the things of God;
- hope enough to remove all anxious fears concerning the future.

BARRY ANDERSON

Congratulations

CORNWELL SCOUT BADGE

J. Tidy Scout, 12th Caterham

BAR TO THE MEDAL OF MERIT

F.A. Rose 1st Lingfield and Dormansland

MEDAL OF MERIT

A.J.M. Hamer V.S.L., 1st Godstone
F.R. Hughes A.D.C., East Surrey
A.J. Osborn A.D.C., East Surrey
Mrs. M.K. Osborn A.D.C., East Surrey

County Diary

March

4 Water Activities Sub-Committee Walton on Thames
6 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking
10 Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club A.G.M. Fetcham
24 County Chaplain's Meeting Dorking
29 District Commissioner's Symposium
31 Programme & Training Sub-Committee Reigate

April

7-12 Scout Job Week
16 Executive Committee London
14 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
29 Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee Ewell

May

11 County Regatta
17-18 Water Activities Leadership Supervisory Skills Course

June

5 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking
7 Chief Scout Award Presentation Walton & Weybridge
9 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
10 Water Activities Sub-Committee Tadworth
13 County A.G.M. Farnham
27/28 Aquameet Longridge

July

5-6 Cubmeet 80 Various
7 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
12-13 District Administrator's Workshop Guildford
13 Venture Scout First Aid Competition
14 Programme & Training Sub-Committee Dorking
16 Executive Committee London
18-20 Venture Scout Camp
29 Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee Ewell

September

8 Water Activities Sub-Committee Walton-o-T
13-14 Scouting for Scout Leaders Bentley Cope
14 Sailing Regatta
18 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking
19-21 National Scouters Conference York
27-28 County Patrol & Camping Competition Walton Firs

October

6 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
11 Chief Scout Award Presentation Banstead
12 Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club Annual Shoot Bisley
13 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
14 Programme & Training Sub-Committee Bookham
15 Executive Committee London
20 County Chaplain's Meeting Dorking
26 Venture Scout Cooking Competition
28 Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee Ewell

November

1 District Commissioner's Symposium
15-16 Venture Competition

December

2 Water Activities Sub-Committee Staines
4 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking

April "Surrey Scout"

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